The Sales Outreach Workflow

SalesGency Outreach OS Playbook · Built by Patrick Diamitani · Diamitani Industries · Nov 9, 2026 · @Patrick Diamitani

Six steps. Everything else is a connector, a prompt, or a tool.

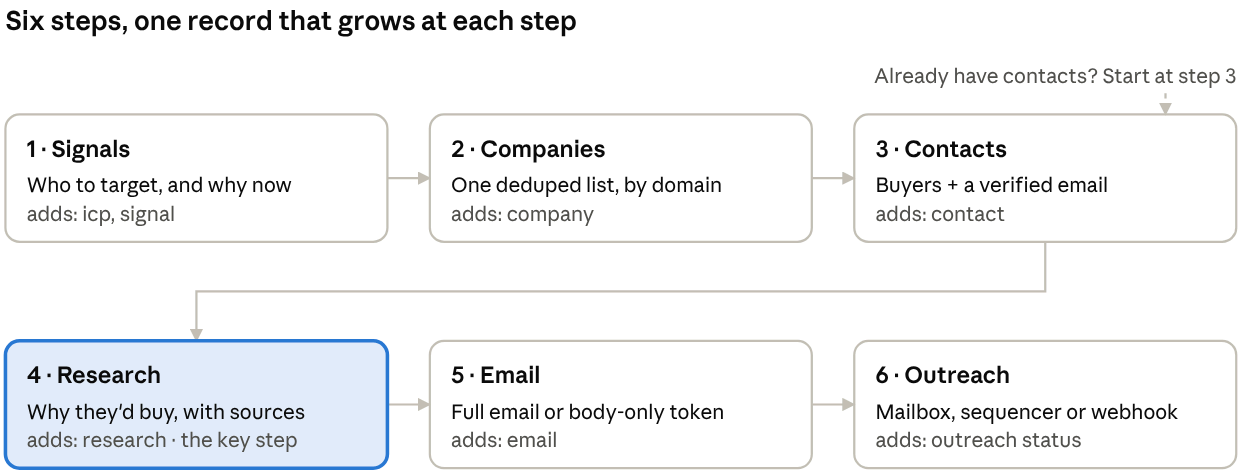
To build a customized prospect automation system you follow six simple steps: identify your signals and ICP, generate a list of company targets, find contact information for your buyer personas, research the prospect and the signal, write a personalized email from that research, and connect it to an outreach tool that enrolls it in a sequence.

That's it. Every vendor, every workflow and every AI agent in outbound is doing one of these six jobs. Once you see the six jobs, you can swap any tool in or out without rebuilding the system.

This playbook gives you, for every step: the questions to answer, the ways the step can be fed, the paid **connector path** and the free **open-source / scripting path**, the best practices, and the KPIs to watch. The same six steps ship as skills for Claude, ChatGPT, Grok, OpenClaw and Hermes, as n8n and Make.com templates, and as the hosted Outreach OS Agent.

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The six steps at a glance



The Sales Outreach Workflow · 6 steps, one record per prospect

Each prospect is one record that grows as it moves: a company, then its signal, the contact, the research, the email, and finally the outreach status. Research is the step that decides whether the email gets a reply. If you already own a lead list, you skip Signals and Companies and start at Contacts.

Step 1 — Signals: know why now, and who

Define the Ideal Customer Profile and the buying signals that mean a company likely needs what you sell right now. A signal is a reason to reach out today instead of next quarter.

Answer first: What do you connect to identify your signals? Is it a workflow from another system, a web search, a general prompt, or just the ICP defined?

Input mode	How it works
ICP defined only	You describe who you sell to; the agent turns it into search criteria and detection queries.
Web search	The agent searches news, job boards, filings and social posts for live signals.
Workflow from another system	A webhook, CRM or intent tool pushes signals in.
General prompt	A free-form prompt describing what to look for.

What good output looks like: an ICP (industries, size bands, geographies, stack clues, personas, disqualifiers) and 5–10 buying signals. Each signal names its type (hiring, funding, leadership change, expansion, tech adoption, regulation, filings language, launch, social post, competitor churn), why it maps to your offer, and the exact query that detects it.

Path	Tools
Connector	Common Room, HubSpot intent, Clay Signals, Bombora / G2 / 6sense, Crunchbase, UserGems, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, PredictLeads

Path	Tools
Open-source / scripting	Web search API (Brave, Exa, Tavily, Firecrawl), Google News RSS, public Greenhouse / Lever / Ashby job boards, SEC EDGAR full-text search, Hacker News and Reddit APIs, GitHub API

- One signal per message: the strongest one wins.
- A signal older than 90 days is context, not a trigger.
- Write the detection query next to every signal so it can be automated.

KPIs: signals found per week, signal-to-meeting rate, average signal age.

Step 2 — Companies: one clean list

However you divide it, break it down to one deduplicated list of target companies or organizations that fit the ICP and, ideally, show at least one signal.

Answer first: Is the list a spreadsheet? Is it from your CRM? Is it webhooked data from another workflow? Or should the agent generate it from the ICP and signals?

The rule that saves the most money: the company's root domain (no `https://`, no `www.`, lowercase) is the primary key. Dedupe on it, and check it against your CRM's customers and open deals, *before* you spend a single enrichment credit.

Path	Tools
Connector	Clay, Apollo, ZoomInfo, Ocean.io (lookalikes), BuiltWith / Store Leads, your CRM (HubSpot, Salesforce, Pipedrive, Attio), Google Sheets / Airtable
Open-source / scripting	CSV or Google Sheets, Supabase / Postgres with a unique index on domain, OpenCorporates and Wikidata, the SEC EDGAR company list, public startup directories scraped with Crawl4AI or Playwright

- Run the CRM dedupe shield before contact enrichment.
- Cap each batch (50–200 companies) so you can review quality before scaling.

- Never fabricate a company or domain; keep the source URL for anything the agent generated.

KPIs: companies added, duplicate rate, ICP-fit rate.

Step 3 — Contacts: reach a person (or their agent)

For each company, find the right one to three people for your buyer personas, with the best email you can verify. Usually that is the economic buyer plus the most likely champion.

There are three ways to get contacts:

1. **Web search / LinkedIn + syntax matching** (publicly available sources). Research the person and find their LinkedIn profile. Work out the company's email syntax in general (first.last@, first@, flast@, firstlast@, firstl@, first_last@), guess the address, and test it: the domain must have an MX record, then a verifier or SMTP check confirms the mailbox.
2. **Data tool.** ZoomInfo, Clay, Apollo and similar: purchase credits or a plan, then sync and filter.
3. **Already have them.** If you bought or own a lead list, skip Steps 1 and 2 and start here.

Path	Tools
Connector	ZoomInfo, Clay waterfall, Apollo, Hunter, Prospeo, LeadMagic, FullEnrich, RocketReach, Lusha, Cognism; verification with ZeroBounce, NeverBounce, MillionVerifier or Reoon
Open-source / scripting	Web search with `site:linkedin.com/in "<title>" "<company>"`, the bundled email-finder script (patterns + MX check), Reacher (self-hosted SMTP verification), team and about pages

- Verify before you send. A bounce rate above 3% damages your sending domain.
- Catch-all domains are "risky": send fewer, watch bounces.
- Keep the source of every email for compliance notes.
- Never use personal emails or phone numbers for cold B2B outreach, and never invent a person.

KPIs: contacts found per company, verified rate, bounce rate.

Step 4 — Research: find out why they might be a customer

This is the most important step. Find out what the prospect, or their company, has said in press, SEC filings, earnings calls, job posts, blog posts and social media that is relevant to what you sell. This step is all about the agent prompts and the connectors for search and scraping.

Every research brief has the same six sections:

Section	What it holds
Company Overview	2–3 sentences: what they do, size, momentum
Prospect Overview	2–3 sentences: role, scope, tenure, anything they have said or posted publicly
Signal — Induced	The direct evidence: a short quote or fact, with source URL and date
Signal — Deduced	What that evidence likely means for their priorities or pain, labeled as inference
Your Company's Products and Services	Which of your offers maps to that pain, and why
Value Proposition	One sentence, in the prospect's language, with a concrete outcome

Path	Tools
Connector	Perplexity API, Exa, Tavily, Firecrawl, Clay Claygent, Apify actors, Common Room, Crunchbase
Open-source / scripting	SEC EDGAR API (10-K, 10-Q, 8-K language), Jina Reader (`r.jina.ai/<url>`), Crawl4AI or Playwright, company newsroom and Google News RSS, the Wayback Machine API

- Separate fact from inference, always. Your credibility is the product.
- One strong, recent, specific signal beats five weak ones.

- Cite a source for every fact. If there is no public evidence, say so rather than invent it.
- Keep the brief under 250 words, and save the sources: the email may cite one.

KPIs: share of high-confidence briefs, sources per prospect, research minutes saved.

Step 5 — Email Personalization: compelling, on-brand, built for a reply

Take the research and ask your agent to write a compelling email based on your company's tone (or the rep's personality), the value proposition and the signal. Keep it inside your industry's best-practice framework so it earns high open and reply rates for this content, this persona and this value proposition.

Settings to give the agent

Setting	Options
Tone	Company voice, or the rep's personality
Style	Informal, or polite
Length	Brief (50–90 words), or detailed (90–150 words)
Links	None, one link, or docs

The framework: line one references the signal specifically (what they said or did), not flattery. One sentence bridges from the signal to the likely pain. One sentence of value proposition with a concrete outcome or proof point. One low-friction, interest-based question as the call to action. Subject line of 2–5 words, specific to them.

The key move: full email or body only

You tell the agent one of two things:

1. **Write the full email**: "Hi First Name," the body, the sign-off and the signature.
2. **Write the body only**: NO INTRO GREETING OR SIGNATURE. The body becomes a messaging token in your CRM or sequencer, dropped into a pre-made sequence template:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

{{email_1_body}}

Best,
{{signature}}
```

Body-only is what lets you scale: the sequence keeps the greeting, signature, follow-ups and unsubscribe handling consistent, while every first touch is personal.

Path	Tools
Connector	Claude, GPT, Gemini or Grok through Vercel AI Gateway or OpenRouter; Lavender for scoring; custom properties in HubSpot, Apollo, Outreach or Salesloft for the token
Open-source / scripting	Local models through Ollama (Llama, Qwen, Mistral), the bundled email linter (word count, spam words, CTA, body-only rules), the kit's tone presets

- Under 125 words, one ask, plain text.
- A/B test the first line, not the whole email.

KPIs: open rate, reply rate, positive reply rate, average email score.

Step 6 — Outreach: something has to do the sending

Connect the finished email to an outreach tool. The question is simple: what is going to do the sending?

Option	How it works	Best for
Mailbox direct	Connect Gmail, Outlook or SMTP straight to your automation tool. Add the subject line, map the email body to the message, and send per row of contacts.	Low volume, founder-led outreach

Option	How it works	Best for
Sequencing platform	Connect it in your automation tool and map it there, or call the API to upsert each contact (with the body as a custom field) and enroll it in a pre-made workflow or sequence.	Volume, follow-ups, mailbox rotation
Webhook / custom	POST the finished record anywhere: a CRM, Zapier, your own sender.	Custom stacks

Pre-flight before anything sends: the email is verified (or risky with explicit approval), the body is present, opt-out handling lives in the destination, the daily cap is respected, and the contact is not already in an active sequence. In the Outreach OS templates, `REQUIRE_APPROVAL=true` holds every email for review until you turn it off.

Path	Tools
Connector	Instantly, Smartlead, Lemlist, Apollo Sequences, Outreach, Salesloft, Reply.io, Amplemarket, HubSpot Sequences, Gmail and Outlook
Open-source / scripting	n8n Send Email or Gmail node, Nodemailer + SMTP, Mautic, Postal (self-hosted mail server)

- Send from separate domains, never your main one; warm them up for 2–3 weeks.
- 30–50 cold emails per mailbox per day, maximum.
- Log every send back to your dashboard and CRM so nobody double-touches a prospect.

KPIs: emails sent, contacts enrolled, bounce rate, reply rate, meetings booked.

Put it to work: stacks, automation and the Outreach OS ladder

Pick a stack per budget, then choose how much of it you want to run yourself.

Budget	Signals	Companies	Contacts	Research	Email	Outreach
$0 (open-source)	Google News RSS + job boards	Google Sheet	Email patterns + MX check + Reacher	Jina Reader + SEC EDGAR + news RSS	Ollama or a low-cost model	n8n Gmail node (low volume)
Lean (about $100–300/mo)	Web search API	Sheet or CRM	Apollo or Hunter + verifier	Firecrawl or Exa	Claude or GPT via AI Gateway	Instantly or Smartlead
Scale	Common Room / Clay signals / intent data	Clay or ZoomInfo + CRM dedupe	Clay waterfall	Perplexity or Exa + Claygent	Claude via AI Gateway + Lavender	Outreach, Salesloft or HubSpot Sequences

Three ways to run the six steps

1. **Skills (any AI assistant).** One skill per step plus an orchestrator, for Claude (plugin with `/outreach-os:*` commands), ChatGPT (Custom GPTs with Actions), Grok, OpenClaw, Hermes, Codex, Cursor, and system prompts for Meta AI and Gemini Gems.
2. **Templates (n8n and Make.com).** A master pipeline plus one workflow per step. One LLM node works with any provider; every data tool is a swappable endpoint; free defaults run on day one. Each template ships with a setup prompt you paste into any AI to configure it for your stack. The n8n master pipeline is tested end to end on n8n 2.46.
3. **The hosted Outreach OS Agent.** Chat with an agent that builds the system for you: it researches and writes, deploys the workflows into your own n8n, runs on a schedule, and tracks every prospect, email and reply on a dashboard. Start with the free Outreach Teardown: enter your website and who you sell to, and get your ICP, buying signals, a research angle and a ready-to-send email in about 30 seconds.

Offer	Price	What you get
Free Outreach Teardown	$0	ICP, signals, research angle and a ready email for your site
Skill & Plugin Pack	$49 one-time	7 skills packaged for every major assistant

Offer	Price	What you get
Template Kit (n8n + Make)	$149 one-time	7 n8n workflows, 7 Make blueprints, setup prompts
Complete Kit	$297 one-time	Skills, packs, templates, this playbook, the tech-stack map, v1 updates
Agent Starter	$49/mo	Hosted agent, 250 researched prospects a month
Agent Pro	$149/mo	1,000 prospects a month, n8n auto-build, daily runs, API and GPT Actions, bring your own key
Agent Scale	$499/mo	4,000 prospects a month, 5 workspaces, sandbox scripts, priority support
Done-for-you	$1,000 Build Session · $2,500 7-day · $5,000 3-day sprint	SalesGency builds it inside your stack

Guardrails that protect your domain and your name

Automation multiplies whatever you feed it, good or bad. These rules are built into every Outreach OS skill and template.

- **Never invent.** No fabricated companies, people, emails, quotes or facts. Research separates fact from inference and cites a source for every fact.
- **Verify before you send.** Keep the bounce rate under 3%. Treat catch-all domains as risky.
- **Protect deliverability.** Send from separate domains with SPF, DKIM and DMARC set up, warm them for 2–3 weeks, and cap each mailbox at 30–50 cold emails a day.
- **Human approval first.** Hold every email for review (`REQUIRE_APPROVAL=true`) until you have read your first 20 and trust the output.
- **Respect the law and the opt-out.** Follow CAN-SPAM, GDPR legitimate-interest rules and CASL where they apply; honor every unsubscribe; keep the source of each contact. This is general guidance, not legal advice.

- **Log everything.** Every send goes back to the dashboard and the CRM so nobody double-touches a prospect.

About the author

Patrick Diamitani builds go-to-market automation systems for a living and runs SalesGency, the GTM consulting and automation brand of **Diamitani Industries**. The Outreach OS is the same six-step method he uses to design prospect automation engines for sales teams, packaged so any team can run it on its own stack.

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